Weiqiang Zhang

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Education

May 2023 – Present
PhD Candidate in Economics, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany
- Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Theocharis Grigoriadis
- Qualifying exams: Econometric Analysis (1.0), Quantitative Macroeconomics (1.7)

2019 – 2021
MSc in International Business — Southeast University, China & Monash University, Australia (Double Master Programme)
- Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Xin Gu Score: 85.75%
- Thesis: *Research on the Impact of Sino-US Trade Frictions on the International Stock Market, Event Study Approach*

2013 – 2017
BSc in Auditing, Shanghai University of International Business and Economics, China
- Score: 76.22%
- Thesis: *Executive Compensation and Corporate M&A in State-Owned Enterprises: An Empirical Study Based on Management Power Theory*

Research Interests

Primary: Political Economy; Institutional Economics; Development Economics; Labor Economics

Further interests: Energy Economics; Environmental and Climate Policy

Work in Progress

Weiqiang Zhang. *Erasing Class: The Rollback of Marxist Political Education and Labor Market Outcomes in China.*

Weiqiang Zhang. *The Yield of Yielding: How Enforcing Pedestrian Rights Promotes Local Commerce.*

Academic Presentations

2026 European Economic Association (EEA) Congress, Dublin, Ireland.

2026 International Economic Association (IEA) World Congress, Belgrade, Serbia.

2026 2nd Berlin PhD Conference in Economics, Berlin School of Economics, Berlin, Germany.

Summer Schools and Workshops

Aug 2026 5th ACES Political Economy Summer School, Association for Comparative Economic Studies (ACES), Kathmandu, Nepal.

Summer 2026 FU Berlin Osteuropa-Institut Economics Research Workshop, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.

Winter 2025 FU Berlin Osteuropa-Institut Economics Research Workshop, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.

Summer 2025 FU Berlin Osteuropa-Institut Economics Research Workshop, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.

Refereed Journal Articles

2026 Jianhui Cong, Rui Li, and Weiqiang Zhang. Winner takes all? Understanding the impact of energy transition on employment under the constraint of China's carbon peak target. *Carbon Balance and Management*, accepted. DOI.

2025 Xiaoxiao Hu, Weiqiang Zhang, Shengling Zhang, Yu Hao, and Jianhui Cong. The impacts of the global energy transition on China's energy security in the long-term: Heterogeneous evidence from the supply and consumption sides. *Renewable Energy*, 255, 123784. DOI.

2023 Jianhui Cong, Weiqiang Zhang, Hongjuan Guo, and Yongbin Zhao. Possible green-technology innovation motivated by China's pilot carbon market: New evidence from city panel data. *Climate Policy*, 1–14. DOI.

2021 Xin Gu, Weiqiang Zhang, and Sang Cheng. How do investors in the Chinese stock market react to external uncertainty? An event study of the Sino-US disputes. *Pacific-Basin Finance Journal*, 68, 101614. DOI.

2020 Xin Gu, Shan Ying, Weiqiang Zhang, and Yewei Tao. How do firms respond to COVID-19? First evidence from Suzhou, China. *Emerging Markets Finance and Trade*, 56(10), 2181–2197. DOI.

2020 Xin Gu, Weiqiang Zhang, Jie Jin, and Zhenyao Liu. An investment risk analysis of the cross-border power interconnection market in countries along the Belt and Road. *Journal of Southeast University (Philosophy and Social Science)*, 22(03), 82–89. DOI.

Refereeing

The World Economy; *Climate Policy*; *Energy Sources, Part B: Economics, Planning, and Policy*; *Utilities Policy*.

Research Experience

Aug 2021 – Apr 2023 **Research Assistant, Shanxi University, China** (Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Jianhui Cong)

- Conducted empirical research on climate change economics and poverty alleviation
- Implemented applied econometric analyses using panel data and difference-in-differences
- Prepared and proofread manuscripts for submission to international journals
- Participated in rural labor force surveys in underdeveloped areas
- Co-authored four refereed journal articles

Sep 2020 – Nov 2021 **Research Assistant, Southeast University, China** (Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Xin Gu)

- Projects funded by the National Social Science Foundation of China, State Grid Suzhou, and Jiangsu Federation of Social Sciences
- Methods: event study designs, difference-in-differences, principal component analysis
- Representative topics: China-US economic cooperation under Dual Circulation; ecological integration index for the Yangtze River Delta; COVID-19 impact on manufacturing in Jiangsu

Professional Experience

Mar – Apr 2019 **Survey Researcher, Institute of Geographic Sciences and Natural Resources Research, Chinese Academy of Sciences** (Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Linxiu Zhang)

- 6th Round of Rural Labour Force Employment and Rural Development Survey (UNEP), Shaanxi Province
- Conducted over 50 household interviews across five poverty-stricken counties
- Topics: land rights, labor employment, agricultural pollution, and poverty alleviation measures

Technical Skills

Methods	Panel data models (FE/RE, IV, DiD); GARCH; Event Study; DSGE (basic).
Software	Stata (advanced); Matlab (intermediate); R (intermediate); Visio (advanced); LaTeX (advanced); CiteSpace (advanced).

Languages

Chinese (native); English (fluent); German (basic).

Grants, Honors, and Awards

2026	**Travel Grant** (€500), Ernst-Reuter-Gesellschaft der Freunde, Förderer und Ehemaligen der Freien Universität Berlin e. V. (ERG).
Nov 2020	Jiangsu Graduate Academic Innovation Forum Best Paper Prize. Awarded for a working paper on the impact of COVID-19 on export-oriented manufacturing firms in China.
Mar 2016	Youth Elite of China 100 (YEC100) Thinking Ability Award. Public welfare project sponsored by the Shanghai municipal government.

References

Prof. Theocharis Grigoriadis, Ph.D.
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